# Lucas Garcia dos Santos

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## Education

**Santa Catarina State University** — Florianópolis, Santa Catarina, Brazil
*Bachelor of Science in Economics* — *2016 — 2019*

**Federal University of Pernambuco** — Recife, Pernambuco, Brazil
*Master of Science in Economics* — *2020 — 2022*

**Southern Methodist University** — Dallas, Texas, United States
*Ph.D. in Economics* — *2022 — Present*

## Research Interests

- Labor Economics
- Public Economics
- Applied Microeconomics

## Working Papers

- **"Universal Cash Transfers and Income Inequality: Evidence from the Alaska Permanent Fund Dividend"**.
**Abstract:** As automation and artificial intelligence reshape labor markets, unconditional cash transfers have gained attention as a potential policy response to rising income inequality. In this paper, I investigate the effects of universal cash transfers on income inequality, using the introduction of the Alaska Permanent Fund Dividend in 1982 as a natural experiment. I focus on total household income inequality using data from the Current Population Survey. Using the synthetic control method, I find that Alaskan income inequality fell after the introduction of the dividend, a reduction of 0.02 in the Gini Index that is not statistically significant. I show that this decrease is consistent with the mechanical effect the policy should produce on its own, which suggests that behavioral responses have a negligible effect on income inequality.

## Works in Progress

- **"Universal Cash Transfers and Higher Education: Evidence from the Alaska Permanent Fund Dividend"**.
- **"The Evolution of Mobile and Manufactured Housing in the United States, 1990-2017"**.

## Publications

- **"Natural disasters and poverty: evidence from a flash flood in Brazil"**. 2024. *Environment, Development and Sustainability. With Marcos Vinicio Wink Junior, Felipe Garcia Ribeiro and Carolina S. Trindade*
- **"Convergence analysis of per capita income in municipalities in the South region of Brazil Between 1999 and 2014."** 2020. *Revista Brasileira de Gestão e Desenvolvimento Regional. With Adriano de Amarante and Fernanda da Silva.*

## Conference Presentations

- **"Universal Cash Transfers and Income Inequality: Evidence from the Alaska Permanent Fund Dividend."** STATA TX Empirical Microeconomics Conference. *October 2025*
- **"Universal Cash Transfers and Income Inequality: Evidence from the Alaska Permanent Fund Dividend."** North Texas Economics Conference. *Upcoming Nov 7*
- **"Universal Cash Transfers and Income Inequality: Evidence from the Alaska Permanent Fund Dividend."** Southern Economic Association Annual Meeting. *Upcoming Nov 21*

## Professional and Research Experience

**Internship** — State Department of Sustainable Economic Development
*Santa Catarina Business Development Program (PRODEC)* — *2017*

**Research Assistant**
*with Dr. Timothy Salmon at Southern Methodist University* — *Summer 2025*

## Teaching Experience

**Teaching assistant** — Undergraduate
*Intermediate Microeconomics - UDESC* — *2018*

**Teaching assistant** — Masters
*Real Analysis - UFPE* — *2021*

**Teaching assistant** — Masters
*Python Programming in Economics - UFPE* — *2022*

**Teaching assistant** — PhD
*Microeconomics, Behavioral Economics, Labor Economics, Econometrics, Experimental Economics - SMU* — *2024-2026*

## Grants and Fellowships

- **Moody Graduate Fellowship.** United States. *2022-Present*
- **National Council for Scientific and Technological Development (CNPQ) Fellowship.** Brazil. *2019-2022*
- **Provost's Summer Research Grant**. United States. *Summer 2026*

## Skills

**Tools** : Python, SQL, LaTeX, STATA, R

**Languages** : Portuguese (native), English